

- 1 The Asiatic lion, *Panthera leo persica*, is found only in the Gir Forest National Park in the Gujarat region of western India.

Fig. 1.1 shows a female Asiatic lion.



Fig. 1.1

- (a) The Asiatic lion is at risk of extinction in the wild and is categorised as endangered by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

Outline the role of the IUCN.

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- (b) The Maldhari community is a tribe of herdsmen that lives in the Gir Forest. The Maldhari have co-existed with the Asiatic lions for thousands of years. The Maldhari place old and weak cattle at the edges of their cattle enclosures.

Suggest why the Maldhari place old and weak cattle at the edges of their cattle enclosures.

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- (c) Some zoos use assisted reproduction techniques, such as IVF, in their captive breeding programmes for endangered species.

Describe how IVF can be used with an endangered species such as the Asiatic lion.

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